Notes on the Music

The pieces collected in this little book are intended for singing and playing at home, in school and in small congregations. Most of them can be learned in a single evening, and none requires more than an ordinary voice or a modest technique at the keyboard. Where a tune is traditional, the setting printed here has been made new; where a text is old, its spelling has been left as the poet wrote it.

Singers reading from a closed score should remember that two parts share each staff: the upper part has its stems pointing up and the lower part has its stems pointing down. When the two parts meet on the same note, a single note head serves for both. Words are printed between the staves and belong to every part unless they are marked otherwise.

Pianists will find that the pieces lie comfortably under the hands. The pedal may be used freely to join the harmonies, but it should be changed with every new chord, and never so heavily that the melody is lost. A slow practice tempo is recommended at first; the marked dynamics are suggestions rather than commands.

Teachers are welcome to copy these pages for their own students. The editor would be glad to hear of any misprints, which will be corrected in a later printing.

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